



Extended chords

Extended chords are formed by taking a seventh chord and continuing to add notes beyond the seventh in patterns of thirds. The ninth, eleventh, and thirteenth chords, shown below, are examples of extended chords. In practice, the fifth, and the note between the seventh and the top note (such as the ninth in an eleventh chord), might be omitted from an extended chord to make the chord easier to play. However, extended chords must always contain a root, third, and seventh, as well as the top note beyond the seventh (ninth, eleventh, or thirteenth).

111 △ C# minor seventh The C# minor seventh is the bass seventh for C# minor extended chords.	112 △ C# minor ninth This chord is formed by taking a C# minor seventh chord and adding a major ninth.	113 △ C# minor eleventh By adding a perfect eleventh to a C# minor ninth chord we get a C# minor eleventh.	114 △ C# minor thirteenth Adding a major thirteenth to a C# minor eleventh chord gives us a C# minor thirteenth.
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Type of extended chord	How it is formed
Major	1 3 5 7 + extension
Dominant	1 3 5 ♭7 + extension
Minor	1 ♭3 5 ♭7 + extension

◁ Types of extended chords

The most common extended chords are major, dominant, or minor. The type of extended chord depends on the type of seventh chord on which it is based.

REAL WORLD

The “Hendrix Chord”

The dominant seventh chord with an added augmented ninth was a particular favorite of the guitarist, singer, and songwriter Jimi Hendrix. He usually featured it in his music as an E7^{#9} chord—an E dominant seventh chord with a top note of F* (or enharmonically, G^b), an augmented ninth above the root note of E. Hendrix’s influence brought this chord, which had previously been associated mainly with jazz, into much wider use in rock music, and it became known as the “Hendrix Chord.”



The **thirteenth chord** is the **largest** possible **extended chord** in **diatonic harmony**.